1. Reading Comprehension

Read the following passage. Then present your interpretation of its connotation in the context of the whole story it belongs to in a passage of about 4–6 sentences in length:

> "Look now in turn at us two, left here all alone—
> our death will be the worst by far, if we defy
> the law, and go beyond the power and vote of kings.
> We must remember, first, that we two are by nature
> women and not fit to fight with men; second,
> that we are ruled by others stronger than ourselves,
> and so must bow to this and even greater griefs.
> So I for one shall beg those underneath the earth
> to pardon me, since I am overpowered by force;
> I shall obey those who are in authority,
> for deeds that are excessive make no sense at all."

— From *Antigone* by Sophocles, in the given textbook, p. 726.

2. Writing

Write an essay of about **1,200–1,500 words** to argue for the following topic:

Magic in the story of "Ma Ha" from *Outstanding Figures in the Vietnamese Zen Community* (*Thiền uyển tập anh*).